

energy from the Sun. However, such leaves also pose a risk in strong winds and heavy snow, so temperate broadleaf trees tend to produce thin leaves that are shed in the fall. The trees remain in an almost dormant state all winter and produce new leaves the following spring.

In the most southerly temperate areas, summers are long, hot, and dry, and winters are warm and wet. The broadleaf evergreen forest that grows in these climates ranges from the tall eucalypts of Australia to the shorter, more open woodland of parts of California and the Mediterranean.

Tropical forests

At the equator, the climate is warm and moist all year round, providing ideal conditions for plant growth and creating the most diverse of all terrestrial habitats. Trees and other forest plants grow in profusion

forming vast rainforests, cloud forests, and montane forests that are green all year round. In the northern tropics, the forests of Southeast Asia are influenced by heavy monsoon rains, giving



MEDITERRANEAN

Broadleaf evergreen forest is also known as Mediterranean forest, and typical trees include cork oaks, some species of pine, and eucalypts. Cork oaks are a particularly important habitat, providing food, shelter, and nesting sites for many species of animal.



TROPICAL DRY

Trees in tropical dry forests survive the long dry season by shedding their leaves, having thick bark, and deep roots that access groundwater. Many species have thorns or spines as a deterrent to animals that might try to feed on them.

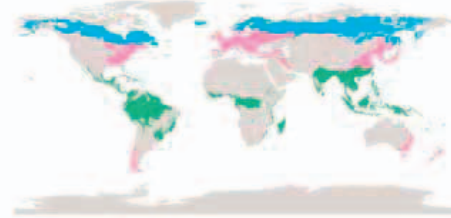


TROPICAL MOIST

The dense canopy of the broadleaf trees growing in most tropical forests holds most of the forest's food. This means that many animals are adapted to life in the trees and are rarely seen at ground level. They include scarlet macaws and spider monkeys.

FOREST DISTRIBUTION

Coniferous forests are generally found at higher latitudes and altitudes than temperate forests, and the boreal forest belt extends to the edge of the Arctic tundra. Tropical forests need warmth year-round and are centered on the equator.



■ Boreal forest ■ Temperate forest ■ Tropical forest

the region distinct wet and dry seasons. During the rains the forest is lush and green but in the dry season, many trees shed their leaves, allowing the sunlight to penetrate to the forest floor.

In areas where there is a long dry season, such as Madagascar and the Caribbean, tropical and subtropical dry forests are found. Composed mainly of broadleaved trees that shed their leaves to conserve water during dry spells, these forests are less diverse than other tropical forests. However, they are still home to a diverse community of animals adapted to cope with the demands of living in a hot, dry climate.